Speaking quý 2. 2023(May to August) by ORIGINAL EXAMS

PART 1

Work and studies

Do vou work or are vou a student?
After I left school, I got a degree in nursing, and l've been working as a staff nurse for almost 10 ears now.
Currently, I'm working at Manilamed, one the best medical centres here in Manila. As a staff nurse, I'm responsible for lots of different things such as preparing patients for examinations and surgery, observing and recording their conditions, measuring and recording their vital signs and weight, administering medications, preparing rooms, cleaning and disinfecting equipment and instruments, or assisting doctors during surgery. Plus, every day I perform a wide range of tasks to provide care to my patients and resolve their problems. For instance, I feed patients who cannot feed themselves, dress patients with physical challenges, help ambulatory patients walk, turn bedridden patients to prevent pressure sores, sometimes I have to transport patients. You see, there's no such thing as a routine day in a hospital, and you just never know what to expect. It's a very tough job, but I like it.

Why did you choose that job?
Well, I guess the primary reason why I decided to pursue a career in Finance was that I really loved Maths at school as I was always good at numbers. And because of this, . thought it was the only possible choice I could make. So it wasn't a tough decision. And, thank God, I have never regretted it.

Why did you choose to study that subject?
Back in the day when I was a high school student, I had an idea that I might like to do something related to fashion, but my parents insisted on my choosing Accounting. Frankly, I wish I hadn't listened to them as I don't really. enjoy being an accountant.

(for people who love challenges) Do you like your job?

Yeah I do. What I love the most about my job is that it never gets boring. Mainly because I have an opportunity. to take on new challenges all the time, which I really like.
In fact, the more challenging the task or the project, the more I like it. You know, if I could do the work with my eyes closed, I swear I would die of boredom, and I would quit my job even though it pays really well. So every time my boss gives me a new challenging task, I feel totally psyched. You know, there is just something beautiful

about encountering obstacles and finding was to overcome them. And then every time I finish a difficult project or task successfully, I feel like I'm flying. My confidence skyrockets and I feel proud of myself, which helps me grow both professionally and personally, and expand my comfort zone.

(for nurses) Do you like your job?

Absolutely. The most rewarding thing about being a nurse is making a difference in the lives of others, whether it be helping patients recover more quickly or helping them pass away as peacefully and comfortably as possible. I find real satisfaction in providing good medical care and emotional support to patients (and oftentimes to their relatives).

Hometown

Please describe your hometown a little.

Tell me a little about the place where you live.
I live in Cebu, which is a bustling and highly urbanized city. in the Philippines with a population of more than 1 million people. It serves as a hub for various industries, including manufacturing, BPOs, commerce, business, agriculture, tourism, which makes it a highly industrialized city. It's pretty much in the middle of the Philippines, so it's relatively easy to get to from anywhere in the country.
Cebu is often referred to as the 'Queen of the South' because of its historical and cultural significance as the first Spanish settlement in the Philippines. By the way, it's the oldest city in the Philippines. It's dynamic, modern and unique in many different ways.

Is that a big city or a small place?
In terms of territory, Manila is one of the smallest cities in the country. For comparison, the total land area of the biggest city in the Philippines, which is Davao City, is approximately 2500 square kilometers, while that of Manila is just about 43 square kilometers. Another way for you to get an idea of Manila's size is to compare it to other well-known cities. For instance, the City of Manila is slightly smaller than the island of Manhattan in New York City and about the same size as the city of Paris, France.

How long have you been living there?

Well, I've been living there since I was born. At times I leave the city just for a while when I go on holidays.

Do you think you will continue living there for a long time?

Every time an opportunity to move to a different place turns up, I come to realise that I want to be here above everywhere else as the city is rich in everything you could possibly desire. There are lots of things to do and places to gO. What is most important for me is that X is the city. of infinite possibilities for ambitious and career-driven people like me as a lot of large international companies have chosen it for their headquarters.

Would you like to live in the countryside in the future?

Oh no! Not until I retire! I'm only 25 and dreaming of a high-flying career, but I'm afraid that living in the countryside will leave my career in tatters. Besides, I'm a very active and sociable person, so I think | will be bored to death being deprived of an active social life and abundance of entertainment options a big city provides.
There's generally not much to do in the countryside, especially in the winter, so I'm sure the majority of young people like to chat with their friend online or play computer games. They may also like to get together in order to play football, ride bicycles or explore the surroundings. This is because if children are not glued to their devices, they usually have active pastime. The more adventurous, the better. Again, as the number of recreational facilities is severely limited in the countryside, it seems to me that the most popular activity with adults is having barbeque parties or just chatting with their neighbours over the fence.

Home, decoration

What colour would you choose to paint the walls of your room?

I would rather choose blue for my bedroom as it is believed to guarantee the best night's sleep by reducing. heart pressure and heart rate. However, I would balance it with warm hues for furnishings and fabrics.

What colour would you never use in your home?
I would avoid stimulating colours, for instance, large splashes of red and yellow or sharp contrasting colours such as black and white. This is because my bedroom should be a place of peace and tranquility rather than a stimulating environment.
I would advise against too much black as it will make me feel on the low side or even depressed. Similarly, I would try to avoid red because I will never have deep sleep or possibly have trouble falling asleep as it is not an easy. bedroom colour to relax.

Which room does your family spend most of the time in?
My dwelling is a one-room minimalist-style flat. I guess if I buy one more piece of furniture, there won't be enough room to swing a cat in my flat. There's a wardrobe with wall-to-wall and floor-to-ceiling mirrored sliding doors.
Were it not for this wardrobe, my room would have got bogged down by clutter. Regrettably, this wardrobe has become a clutter hot spot itself, but all the disarray is inside so nobody sees it. There is also a wall-mounted flat-screen TV and a bed

What do you like about your flat?
What I particularly like is that it reflects my_personality, so I feel really comfortable being at home. Also, it gives me the feeling of stepping into a safe, personal refuge.

What can you see from the windows where you live?
Unfortunately, as I live in a huge industrial city, every time 1 look out of the window, I see nothing but concrete jungle.

Do you prefer living in a house or a flat?

I would rather live in a house as I would be able to do almost anything I want without disturbing other people.
What I mean is when you live in a flat, even if you speak loudly, your neighbours start complaining. But when you live in a house, you can listen to music, laugh, dance and, if you do it with a reasonable amount of consideration, no one will even notice anything.

What would you like to change in your flat?

I would like to breathe more life into it by hanging some paintings on the walls or putting a potted plant on the window sill.

Chocolate ((May to August 2023)

Do you like chocolate?
Oh, yeah! I can't live a day without it. It's a kind of antidepressant for me. It helps me to reduce stress and gives a refreshing effect to my brain. I always feel elated after eating chocolate and can't avoid the temptation to eat it again and again.

Do you like chocolate?
Oh, no, I don't. I don't like any sweets at all except for fruits. Chocolate and stuff like that are too heavy for me. What's more, they leave an unpleasant aftertaste. So, no, it's not my type of delight.

Did you like chocolate when you were a child?
Definitely. I think there are no kids in the world who don't enjoy eating chocolate. I really adored that melt- in-my mouth feeling every time I popped a piece of chocolate in my mouth and always waited for chocolate surprises from everyone coming to our place.

Did you give chocolate as a present to someone?
Millions of times, actually. First of all, it's a traditional present on St Valentine's Day. It symbolizes affection, attraction, deep love, luxury, passion and sensuality. What is more, I think it's an exciting sweet surprise for children which makes them really happy and a perfect "thank you' gift to colleagues, friends, teachers and employers.

Staying up late ((May to August 2023)

Do you go to sleep early or stay up late?
Well, I normally go to bed at about 10 p.m. as I believe there's no point sacrificing sleep for other activities. No matter how important they might seem, the benefits of doing them will not outweigh the harm sleep deprivation will do to my health.

How do you feel in the morning after you stay up late?
You know, I'm like a zombie the next day. I drink coffee nonstop, but usually it doesn't help a lot. And this overcast feeling follows me until nighttime.

What were you doing when you stayed up late last time?
Oh, last Sunday I promised myself to go to bed before midnight, but I binge-watched the entire season of Wednesday, and went to bed at 4 am.

Outer space and stars ((May to August 2023)

Do you want to travel in the outer space?
Of course I do. I love space and I am sure travelling there would be a great experience. I'll get a chance to float around, discover new planets and see aliens. So yeah, I'd really love to try it.

What would you do if you had an opportunity?
If I had an opportunity, I would definitely take it as I've been dreaming about space travel since my childhood. I know that the amount of training I'd have to do before such

a trip is quite big and I know that it can be dangerous as I might get lost or run out of oxygen but still I'd no doubt seize this chance.

Have you ever learnt about stars and outer space?
Yes, I once tried it. It was an online course and I took it last summer. I wanted to learn information about distant past and future of Earth, the Sun and our universe and I was satisfied with the knowledge and learning experience the course provided me with. No, never. I can even say that I have never thought about it. Maybe it's because I have a list of more important courses I would like to take in the not-too- distant future.

Is it important to study stars?
I am sure it is. Stars help people understand how our solar system was formed, give a lot of information about the physical world and have influence on people's life. So it's really important to study them.

Jewelry ((May to August 2023)

Have you ever sent someone jewelry as a gift?
Oh yeah, I do it quite often 'cause my beloved one really likes to adorn herself with different jewelry items, and I really like to make her feel happy.

Have you ever sent someone jewelry as a gift?
Oh yeah, I've done it a couple of times. Both jewelery gifts were for my best friend who lives abroad these days. I just wanted to let her know that I care and raise a smile on her face.

Music ((May to August 2023)

What kinds of music do you like to listen to?
I am a music lover so I enjoy listening to different kinds of music because any music be it classical, electronic or pop creates some feelings in my soul. Moreover different kinds of music influence me in different ways, for example classical music lessens depression whereas rock music evokes strong memories.

When did you start listening to that type of music?

I started listening to pop music at a very early age, guess I was around 5 or 6 years old. This catchy and easy-listening music tempted me and I just couldn't help listening to it. As far as rock is concerned, I fell in love with it in my early twenties after I heard the Rolling Stones' 'Paint it black'

Do you often listen to music?
It seems I listen to it all the time. I do it while working, driving a car, spending time on the Internet, walking. down the street, working out, cooking and even lying. around. So yeah, I can say that I listen to music my. entire day.

When do you listen to music?
Well, I would say I listen to music whenever I can but I mostly do it when I am out of work and have free time though sometimes I turn on music at work when I need to focus on some important task

How much time do you spend listening to music every day?
I guess I spend about 70 percent of my time listening to music. I listen to it my entire day while working, walking,. driving a car, cooking, surfing the Internet. So year guess at least 70 percent of my day.

How do you feel when you listen to it?
I feel elated when I listen to the music I like. I just melt into the melody and flow with the rhythm. It makes me relieved, pumped up and really blissful.

Small businesses ((May to August 2023)

Do you prefer buying things in big companies or from small businesses?
Oh, definitely from small businesses as, first of all, small businesses always do their best to be competitive and provide the best price. Secondly, they are more likely to provide better customer service if there are any problems with the merchandise as all purchases, deals and positive reviews matter for them. And, of course when I buy from small companies, I cycle money back into my community and, thus, support the local economy.

Do you know many small businesses?
Yeah, there are lots of small businesses where I live. I mean pizza parlors, coffee shops, restaurants, barber shops and retail outlets. Nowadays many people prefer to start small business 'cause they want to have the freedom to fill smaller niches with less common and more innovative products.

Weekends (January - August 2023)

What do you usually do at weekends?
What did you do last weekend?
What do you do on weekends?
Well, it largely depends on whether I'm tired or not. If I had a hard working week, I usually sleep in and then stay in bed for half a day doing absolutely nothing or at least nothing that involves much brainwork. Then I may either read a book or surf the Net. If I don't feel like a squeezed lemon, I like meeting friends. We usually either walk in the park or go to the cafe to drink coffee and chat.

Do you like weekends?
To tell the truth, I don't like weekends because I realise that this is the only time when I can do all my household chores such as cooking or cleaning. This is because on work days I cannot make myself do it. But, of course, sometimes I dedicate time to my hobbies, visit my parents who live out of town or go to a beauty salon.

Do you think it is important to make the most of your weekend?
I believe it's not just important, but essential to have enough rest during the weekend because we aren't robots and our brain and body cannot work nonstop maintaining the same levels of productivity. If you don't get enough rest, the only likely outcome is a burnout. So weekends serve as a so-called system reboot after which you will feel rested and energetic and therefore satisfied with your life.

T-shirts ((May to August 2023)

Do you usually wear T-shirts?
Do you like wearing T-shirts?
Yeah I do. To my mind, a T-shirt is always a good choice. First of all, T-shirts are super comfy. They are usually made of cotton, which is regarded as one of the most skin-friendly fabrics. Plus, T-shirts are versatile. can dress them up or down, depending on the occasion. For example, I sometimes throw on a pair of jeans and some sneakers for a casual look. Sometimes I tuck a T-shirt into a skirt and add some heels for a dressed-up outfit. And, of course, they're perfect for lounging around the house.

Would you buy T-shirts as souvenirs on vacation?
Oh yeah, I would as T-shirts may serve as a reminder of the vacation and can be a great conversation starter.
Plus, T-shirts are comfortable to wear and can be a great way to show off the memories I made on my trip.

•Would you buy T-shirts as souvenirs on vacation?
Yeah, why not... T-shirts are a great option for souvenirs because they're practical, affordable and may serve as a constant reminder of my trip. I especially like T-shirts that feature local landmarks, festivals or cuisine as they bring. an authentic flavor to the destination. Plus, I-shirts are a great gift option for friends and family who couldn't make the trip with me.

do you think older people who wear T- shirt are fashionable?

Yes, older people who wear T-shirts can certainly be fashionable. However, it's not the age of the wearer or the item of clothing itself that makes someone fashionable, but rather how they wear it and how it fits into their personal style. With the right choice of T-shirt, fit, and styling, older people can look stylish and fashionable in a T-shirt. The key is to choose T-shirts that flatter their body shape, complement their personal style, and are appropriate for the occasion.

Happiness ((May to August 2023)

What made you happy when you were a child?
Well, when I was a child, I felt happy every time I went to the seaside with my parents and grandparents as ! really enjoyed playing in the water, building sandcastles and having fun outdoors with my family and new friends. Another thing that made me happy when I was a kid was doing different experiments which let me learn how things work, how they look inside and how they are made. Oh, and the last thing that made me happy was receiving presents I wanted. Yeah, I must admit that gifts make me happy even these days.

when do you feel happy at work?

Oh, I feel happy at work when I'm given challenging projects that allow me to utilize my skills and creativity. I also feel happy when I have a supportive team that works well together and helps me when I need it. And of course, it's a great boost to my confidence and happiness at work when I receive recognition for my efforts and hard work.

Do you feel happy when you buy new things?

No. I don't believe that material possessions can bring true happiness. Sure, they may provide temporary pleasure, but true happiness comes from within. It's about having a sense of purpose, strong relationships, and inner peace. Material things are fleeting and will never bring the long-term satisfaction and fulfillment that comes from living a meaningful life.

Art ((May to August 2023)

Do you like art?
Oh yeah, I do as I always have that warming feeling. when I look at artworks. It's so interesting for me to figure out the hidden symbolism that artworks portray. What is more, art helps me forget about my worries as the moment I indulge deep into the artwork my thoughts and emotions change for the better. Do you like art? Well, I'd just say that I don't care about it. It's so boring for me to look at all these works of art that I just try to avoid it.

Do you like modern art or traditional art?
Personally, I'm more of a fan of modern art. I love how it breaks awav from traditional forms and conventions and allows for personal interpretation and emotional connection. The themes it explores, like identity, mortality, and the human experience, really resonate with me**.**

Do you think it would be interesting for you to be an artist?
Well, it actually could be quite interesting for me to be an artist as it's my passion to create beauty through art. Art definitely inspires me and I guess creative work could give my life some special meaning. So, yeah, I would enjoy doing the work of an artist, I think.

Have you ever visited an art gallery?

Of course, I have. I'd even say I've done it a million times.

[actually do it every time I visit a new city as art is a remarkable mode of depicting culture, and it's just impossible, to my mind, to get an accurate picture of a new place without looking at its artworks.

Noise ((May to August 2023)

Do you mind noises?
I would say I'm pretty tolerant to noises when I'm not asleep as I've learned to cut out the unwanted ones. But when I am about to fall asleep, I become very sensitive to any kind of noise, and nearly anything can make me irritated. Sometimes I toss and turn throughout the night just because I hear the muffled sound of slammed doors in the flat next door.

Do any noises bother you?
There's no worse noise than scraping chalk on a blackboard. You know, many cafes still use such boards as an advertising medium. When I see them, I can't help imagining the way this information was written down. And even the thought of it makes me feel sick.

Are cities becoming noisier?

Where is there louder noise, in cities or in the countryside?

Yeah, the level of noise is getting higher and higher. In fact, it is so high that it is now regarded a type of environmental pollution. This is because nowadays cities are more crowded than in the past, which means that there's much more traffic on roads. There are more people talking everywhere. Oh, and I nearly forgot to mention air conditioning equipment which is one of the biggest parts of all ambient noise in today's cities.

What type of noise do you come across in your daily life?
We are surrounded by different sounds both indoors and outdoors. My typical day starts with the sound of boiling water as I can't imagine my morning without a cup of coffee. Every single day I'm accompanied by roaring engines, slammed doors, mouse clicking and constantly ringing phones.

Are there any sounds that you like?
Oh yeah! Splashing waves and screams of sea-gulls sound like music to me. I also enjoy the sound of rain when I'm inside and don't have to go anywhere. And I can't help

mentioning the train tracks clanking in the constant pattern. This sound makes me fall asleep as soon as the train leaves.

Key

Have you ever locked yourself out?
Yes, I have actually locked myself out before. It was during a busy day and I was in a hurry, so I rushed out the door without grabbing my keys. I felt pretty silly standing outside my own front door, but thankfully a neighbor was able to help me get back in. I now always double-check to make sure have my keys before I leave the house. It was definitely a good lesson learned.

Do you think it's a good idea to leave your keys with a neighbour?
Well, leaving a spare set of keys with a neighbor can be a good idea if this neighbour is a trustworthy and reliable person who I know will keep them safe. However, it's important to weigh the potential risks involved, such as the loss or theft of the keys, lack of privacy, and potential legal and liability issues.

Have you ever lost your keys?
Oh yeah, I've definitely lost my keys before. It's one of those things that can happen to anyone at any time. I remember once I lost my keys for a whole day and it was so frustrating because I had places to go and things to do. But eventually, I found them in the pocket of a jacket I hadn't worn in a while. It was a huge relief! But thankfully, it doesn't happen to me too often.

Do you always bring a lot of keys with you?
Oh no, no way. I only have 5 keys in my bag pretty much of the time as I need them every working day. They are a key fob for a building where I live, my apartment key, my car key, a keycard to my office building and a keycard to my parking lot. And I can't imagine having to bring more keys with me as, first of all, I like carrying cross-body bags which, unfortunately, don't have a lot of extra storage space inside. Secondly, I don't want my bag to be too heavy because of too many metal keys in it.

Library

Did you go to a library when you were a kid?
Yes, I loved going to the library as a child. It was always a special treat for me to go and pick out new books to read.
I would spend hours browsing the shelves, and the librarians were alwavs so helpful and friendly.

What kind of people would go to a library to read and study?
Well, libraries are a hub of activity and attract a diverse range of people seeking knowledge, information, and intellectual stimulation. Students of all ages, from elementary school children to graduate students, often flock to libraries to study and complete assignments.
Researchers and scholars visit libraries to access specialized collections and archives, as well as to work on their latest projects in a quiet and focused environment.
Writers and artists also use libraries as a source of inspiration and reference material for their work, as well as a place to study and research. For job seekers, libraries provide access to job listings, resources for interview preparation, and a quiet place to work on resumes and cover letters. Retirees may use libraries to stay active and engaged in learning, and to access information on topics of interest. In addition to serving individuals, libraries often serve as community centers, offering resources and programs for residents of all ages and backgrounds, such as classes, workshops, and events. To sum up, libraries offer something for everyone, making them a valuable resource and gathering place for the entire community.

Do you often go to the library?
Yeah. Libraries are the best choice when I need some information on a new topic as they have a lot of archival materials. Also, there are knowledgeable and friendly. librarians who assist with locating information.
Regrettably, the Internet gives just a small percentage of what is published and even when it does give the information on the topic I need to learn, this information often turns out to be inaccurate and misleading, which pushes me to return to the library again and again.

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School

What changes would you like to see in your school?
One of the changes I'd like to see in my school is an improvement in the technology and infrastructure. This includes upgrading equipment, increasing access to digital

resources, and implementing effective online learning tools. With the integration of technology.. students can benefit from a more engaging and interactive educational experience, which can help to enhance their overall learning. In addition, the use of technology can streamline administrative tasks, freeing up more time for teaching and learning. So, I guess it's a priority change I'd like to see.

Did you go to a good school?

Oh yeah, I went to a very good school which had high standards of teaching as well as fair-minded, skilled and supportive teachers who always found ways to make the students motivated and engaged. Also, my school had state-of-the-art supplies such as sports equipment,. library books, laboratory equipment and computers along. with clean and well-organized school premises that were conducive to learning and helped kids develop their skills and grasp knowledge.

REAL IELTS EXAMS

PART 2

Describe a period in history that interests you

You should say:
what the period is
how you know about it
why it is interesting
Part 3 for this cue card is 'History'

I like anything that is connected with ancient Rome. I'm not good at history, but I know for sure that there were indeed greater and more advanced civilizations, they died and left almost nothing behind, but Rome's rich legacy of innovation and invention can still be seen today in many spheres of our life. Just the fact that most people in the world write in roman letters tells a lot.

However, to my regret, I got interested in it only recently when I came across some article on the Internet. After that I read tons of them and watched a lot of TV programs and drama series featuring this period in history. Now I can safely say that Romans, however pompous this may sound, had the biggest impact on the development of modern society.

For example, Roman numerals are being widely used nowadays. Like us, or probably it's more correct to say like them, we divide the day into 24 hours. Another interesting fact is that Rome, according to numerous articles, was the first entity that started managing large areas and populations in an organized fashion. The Romans were renowned as great engineers. They gave the world the true arch which allowed to build long span bridges, and they were famous for their road systems because creating a vast network of roads was the only possibility to provide connection between different regions of this vast empire in order to ensure mobility of population, military troops and to facilitate trade. What's interesting is that these roads survived through the subsequent middle ages right up to the modern times. One of the most impressive features of ancient Rome along with their roads was the aqueducts that were constructed to bring water from the distant areas This water was then used to provide for public baths, fountains, and for use in private households. Perhaps most impressive of all, Roman aqueducts were so well built that some are still in use to this day. They also created complex sewage systems that were used to remove the waste water and release it into water bodies. I could spend hours talking about their amazing achievements.

Describe something you did with a group of people

You should say:
what it was
where you did it
who you were with
whether you liked it

Several weeks ago, my friends and I had our weekend get-together. And at some point, we realised that all of us wanted to do something more entertaining than just sitting around and chatting. One of my friends suggested trying an escape room, you know, a game in which a team of people is locked in a room. And they must find clues and solve puzzles to complete a given mission and find the key to escape. I GOT SUPER PSYCHED ABOUT THE IDEA 'cause it was something I hadn't done before. We did a quick online search for escape rooms in that area and chose the one that had lots of good customer reviews. There were 4 of us. We were kind of spies who broke into someone's house to find some secret files. Frankly speaking, I don't remember the storyline in detail, but remember that we had one hour to escape the room to avoid being caught and imprisoned.

The room, in which we were locked, was packed with different stuff such as books, maps, fedoras, magnets, sticky notes, watches, old wigs, compasses, lamps, board games, playing cards. We were frantically searching for clues. Some of them involved solving riddles, putting items in the correct order, or finding a set of objects hidden in the room. The puzzles were really challenging.

And it was really fun. What I will never forget is that there was a broken clock, and for a long time we couldn't figure out that we had to pay attention to the time it stopped on. By the way, it appeared to be the last clue.

It was completely different from what we usually do together. And to tell the truth, I didn't expect it to be so exciting.

Unusual meal ((May to August 2023)

Describe an unusual meal
You should say:
what who organised this meal and where you had it
what you talked about during the meal
what you ate and drank
why it was special

Part 3 for this cue card is 'Eating out'

I like tasty food. I mean I can't say I'm a gourmet, but won't eat anything and everything even when I'm very hungry. So everyone knows that inviting me to a good restaurant is a perfect way to please me. One day my boyfriend invited me to eat out. It was our dating anniversary so I understood we wouldn't go to McDonald's. But I couldn't even imagine that he would invite me to the most expensive restaurant in our city. was blown away when he told me where we were going to have dinner. I got an opportunity to try some exclusive super expensive dishes that I only heard about and saw in pictures.

I really wanted to try oysters as there were so many people who loved them and the same number of people who hated them. So, on the one hand, I wanted to form my own opinion about this type of seafood. On the other, I was a bit afraid. We ordered a large plate of oysters with very dry white wine. Although they were expensive, I thought there wouldn't be a better chance in the near future, so I was determined to taste them come what may. My boyfriend started eating them, saying every other second how delicious they were. I plucked up my courage, took the first oyster and slurped it before I had a change of heart. I liked it. You know if they hadn't been so expensive, I would have eaten three times as much. Now I understand why they are considered culinary delicacy. I also persuaded my boyfriend to cook fuagra and some other sophisticated dishes. This was a gastronomic delight.

This dinner was unusual because I had never tried so many culinary delicacies during one meal before. It was easily the best meal in my life. And I was happy I decided to say 'yes' to something that I would normally refuse to eat.

Website ((May to August 2023)

Describe a website you often visit
You should say:
what the website is
how you first found out about this website
how often you visit it
why you like it
Part 3 for this cue card is 'Internet, TV, libraries'

Once a friend of mine asked me whether I had ever been on the social networking website known as facebook.com. However, back in the day I didn't have the slightest

inkling of what Facebook was. And, frankly speaking, I didn't want to sign up. But my tech-savvy friend bombarded me with links so that, in the end, I even started feeling an overwhelming desire to do so. It was not until I started using facebook that I realized how much I had been missing out on my life as it offered a flurry of benefits to enjoy. I have to say that now I visit it whenever I have a spare moment. Initially it was set up solely as a social network just to help people get hold of friends but it gradually became an epicenter of all kinds of human activity, be it in the sphere of business, education or entertainment.

For one thing, were it not for this website, I would still have to arrange face-to-face meetings to stay up to speed with what my friends are doing. Now all the updates are posted to their feed; therefore both tracking down old friends and renewing long-forgotten friendships do not seem as challenging a task as it used to be due to the fact that some of them may not have phones, but all of them do have internet-enabled devices and their online status indicator icons never stop blinking even in the depth of night.

More importantly, an opportunity to increase my. business's efficiency and expand clientele absolutely free of charge is what I consider by far the greatest benefit of using this website. The information about my company's services can be disseminated in the blink of an eye, just at a click of a button. And target audience is global.

Besides, I can do social good every day. When I cannot donate to those who are in need on the score of pecuniary problems, I can do my bit, making numerous reposts.

Piece of technology ((May to August 2023)

Describe a piece of technology that you feel difficult to use
You should say:
what it is
what you got it for
how often you use it
how you feel about it
Part 3 - 'Technology

I had been an Android user for many years when last week I decided to buy an IS device. For many years I was rolling my eyes at iPhone fanboys and fangirls. But recently I decided to find out what it is about the iphone that gets people so crazy. So I bought my first iPhone at the Apple store. In my opinion, it's worse than Android. It's different from Android. I just can't get used to it.

First of all, when I started using an iPhone, I found out there was no 'back' button. The 'back' function on is worked into the apps, on screen. I have difficulty in getting used to this. I sometimes find myself clicking on an imaginary 'back' button. Also, I found out that not all the apps that I liked using on my Android device have iPhone versions. I feel so frustrated. Another thing that I can't get used to is the way a notification system works On my Android device, notifications were displayed on the lock screen and could be swiped away or tapped to open. On an iPhone, notifications are displayed in the center of the screen and must be tapped to open. And there are lots of other minor differences that drive me crazy.

City ((May to August 2023)

Describe a city where you'd like to stay for a short time
You should say:
what city it is
who you will go there with
what you will do there
why you will stay there only for a short time
Part 3 for this cue card is 'Cities'

Well, I'm planning to spend some time in Barcelona in the near future. I visited the city a couple of years ago and really enjoyed my experience there. Since then, I've been wanting to go back and stay for longer than just a few days. However, I'm not sure if I'm ready to live in Barcelona permanently. I think I'm too young to settle down. To be honest, right now the word 'settle' puts me into a cold sweat. I'm still searching for a perfect place to live, work and raise a family. And because of this,. want to travel and see different parts of the world before I find a place I will be willing to connect to. Who knows? In the end, after having tried out a number of options, I might want to return to Barcelona and put down roots there 'cause it really is one the best places I've ever been to.

It is a huge and bustling city., which I like a lot. There's always so much to do and see. I mean It's so large that if you view the city from a tall building, you get the feeling that it doesn't end. At the same time, it's compact. You know, I don't want to feel like a pebble of sand in the big ocean. So the fact that it's nowhere near as big as New York appeals to me greatly. Plus, it's the most walkable city of all. You can literally walk for days and still have something new to see. And I'm a keen walker. So I will walk, try local food, visit famous attractions, do some shopping, and explore job opportunities.

Teaching a friend or relative (May to August 2023)

Describe a time when you taught a friend or relative something
You should say:
what you taught them to do
whom you taught
how you taught them
how you felt about it
part 3 - 'Skills'

Some years ago I taught my nephew to tie shoelaces. thought it would be a piece of cake as it takes no more than two seconds to do it. And we, adults, do it automatically without thinking about it. I mean it's as natural as breathing. So I thought I would show it once or perhaps twice and it would be done, but sometimes things don't go like we think they will. This was just the case. He couldn't repeat after me. So it turned out to be one of the biggest challenges in my whole life. My mom told me that this process could take up to a month of consistency and dedication from both the teacher and child (and a lot of patience)

I understood that, first of all, I myself had to learn how to teach somebody. So, I watched a number of video tutorials which showed different ways to teach a child to tie shoelaces. After that we started practising 5 minutes every day, and I broke down this complicated task into smaller steps in order not to overwhelm the child.

At first, we practised with his shoes off. I used laces of two different colors to help him differentiate one lace from the other. We started from learning to make a starting knot. I showed him how to cross the left end of the lace over the right one, then wrap one end around the other, and pull both ends to complete the knot.

When he finally succeeded, we moved on to a more complicated task. I started teaching him to make both ends into "loops' that look like bunny ears, and then repeat all those steps that I've already described. Every day we took one small step forward. Everything was ok when we did it together, but when I asked him to do it himself, it was terrible. It was as if he had never practised anything before. Several times I was on the verge of losing my temper. But I didn't give up. It was a challenge for me. I wanted to see what I was capable of as a teacher. When it all was over and he managed to tie his first shoelaces single handedly, I had a sense of satisfaction and relief.

Meeting you missed or were late for (May to August 2023)

Describe a time when you missed or were late for a meeting
You should say:
what the appointment was
when and where it was
why you forgot about it
how you felt
part 3 - 'Punctuality

This mishap happened to me a long while ago, but I still remember it like it was yesterday. My best friend and I decided to meet for lunch because she was really busy at work and because of that we hadn't seen each other for several weeks. So, one day when I was supposed to be at the cafe, was doing some work in the office like nothing was wrong. It was only when I saw my friend's name on the screen of the phone that I remembered about our meeting.

I was more than shocked. The only thing I wanted was to sink into the ground. I completely forgot about it. It just slipped my mind. I realised how terrible this situation was. My friend dropped everything in order to meet me, although she was really busy, and I just didn't show up. I felt ashamed for what had happened and I didn't even have any excuses. I was feeling guilty as she was waiting for me instead of doing something useful. I was afraid she could think that I don't appreciate our friendship or that I don't respect her time. Also, I was shocked because nothing like that had ever happened to me before. I didn't know how to deal with this mishap. Of course, I apologized one hundred times, but it didn't help me to feel better as I understood she had wasted so much time because of me.

Polluted place (May to August 2023)

Describe a place you visited that was affected by air pollution
You should say:
where it is and when you visited this place
why the air was not good
how this place was affected
how you felt about it

part 3 - 'Pollution'

Nowadays we don't need to go far to find vivid examples of polluted places because pollution is a modern plague both indoors and outdoors. Frankly speaking, I had thought I was living in a very polluted city until I went on a business trip to a large industrial one called City.

I went there by car. At some point of my journey, I noticed a dark cloud in a distance. The closer I got, the larger the cloud grew. Soon I realised that it was a thick blanket of smog hanging over the city. What I saw when I arrived was beyond the limits of my imagination. I was even afraid to leave my car. The whole city was shrouded in smog. Just imagine, it was so thick that I could hardly see my feet as I walked through it. I doubt that people living there were lucky to see the sun every day. Wherever I looked, I saw dark circles of smoke exuding from pipes. Needless to say, there weren't many trees there. Those which I could notice were covered with a thick layer of particulate matter. This means they must have stopped producing oxygen a long time ago. The entire city turned into a biologically dead zone. The river which passes through the city was only used for dumping toxic waste from plants and factories. Swimming there was definitely out of question. So it's perfectly natural that it was really difficult for me to breathe. Several hours after I arrived I started coughing nonstop. I still can't imagine how people could live there for long periods of time. Fortunately, I had to spend just one day there and couldn't wait to get in my car and drive home.

Development in your city (May to August 2023)

Describe a new development in your city (for example, a shopping mall or leisure facilities)

You should say:
what it is and where it is
how long it took to complete it
what you think of it
Part 3 for this cue card is 'Transportation, leisure facilities'

In my city shops spring up like mushrooms, but almost all of them aren't even worth mentioning because of their poor range of goods, poor service and exorbitant prices. The only recent development that made my life much easier is a hypermarket that opened several months ago. Actually, there is one more big-box store in my city, the one where I used to do all my shopping, but it is situated on the other end of the city, so it took me way too much time to get there and back. This one is also located on the outskirts of the city, but it's much closer to my home, which is really convenient and

saves a lot of my time. The only thing that makes me upset is that it occupies the territory which used to be a football field.

Like all hypermarkets, it sells a lot of different types of goods from toothpaste to household appliances and provides consumers with all the goods they require,. under one roof. What I particularly like is that it has a huge variety of products that I just haven't seen anywhere else. At the same time, whatever I find there is going to be affordable. I recently got a T-shirt for $2 where I would have paid more than $5 elsewhere. I also have big savings on products that I buy in bulk, for example, bottled water, kitchen paper, washing powder and many other things like these. Also, product categories are well organised so that I can find different items I'm looking for in one location. What's more, they keep complementary products in proximity so I don't have to go around the shop several times. Oh, I nearly forgot, it's open round the clock, so I can go there work on week days, thus, I don't have to make time for shopping at weekends. Instead, I spend more time friends and family. I'm really happy that now I can do shopping much faster and spend much less money than before.

Old person (May to August 2023)

Describe an interesting old person
You should say:
who this person is
how you know this person
what you do or did together
why you think this person is interesting
part 3 - 'Old people, selfishness'

I live in a crowded high-rise building, and have neighbours next door, below and above. I guess, about a hundred people in total. So it's not surprising that most of them are nameless and faceless to me. The only person who stands out is my next-door neighbour This is an elderly man whose name is John. He's been living next door ever since I can remember. So I can say I've known him since my childhood

John is retired now. And if I were him, I would sleep late, but he wakes up at 5 or 6 a.m. and always starts his day with morning exercises. He goes jogging, I think, every day

regardless of the weather and the season. It's incredible. He's in his late 70s. I'm just 35 but I'm nowhere near as energetic as he is. I just can't help admiring him.

Another thing that draws people to him is that he will never say 'no' if you ask him to water your flowers when you're away, keep an eye on your flat or feed your pets I used to think he does it not to feel lonely, but some time ago I understood that this is just because he is a really caring and considerate person What's more, whatever happens, he looks on the bright side of life. Whenever I meet him, he is in a good mood with a big smile on his face. He never complains about his life although my parents told me that he'd got through lots of challenges. I wish there were more people like him.

Feeling proud (May to August 2023)

Describe something you did that made you feel proud
You should say:
what the achievement is
how you did it
how difficult it was
why you are proud of it
Part 3 for this cue card is 'Goals, rewards, feeling proud'

Well, it's probably difficult to believe, but last year ! knocked off X kilos in about 6 months, and this is what I'm still enormously proud of. I have to confess... I used to be a very lazy girl who loved fast food and hated sports. And at that time I was so slim that I didn't even think that one day being overweight would become my number 1 problem. So when I realised that I'd put on X kilos, I decided to lose weight and get fit, no matter what.

And so it began. I started I exercising daily. I went jogging in the mornings and I walked in the evenings Also, I ditched junk food and stopped buying snacks which I couldn't live without. I started sticking to a diet You know, no sweets, no rice, no cheeseburgers and French fries. Nothing. Only salads, vegetables, fruits and plenty of fluids. I ate only healthy food and drank a lot of water daily. I cooked foods in healthier ways such as boiling, baking and stewing. I read somewhere that it is better to have free light meals instead of one main practice for sex straight months. As a result, I lost more than X kilograms.

Now I'm not only as slim as I used to be, but I'm also fit enough. And I'm genuinely proud of my achievement. I should say it was hard to change my habits, my diet and my lifestyle, and at some point I was about to give up because all those activities were

really time consuming. But I didn't, thank God, though I was facing a lot of difficulties. Another thing that makes me feel inordinately proud of myself is that I achieved great results without anybody's help. I just read blogs and forums, used a lot of online resources, but it was I that decided what to do with myself. This is something I never thought I could do. You can't even imagine how much effort I put in achieving this result. I would even say I was fighting the battle of my life. And I won.

Free time activity (May to August 2023)

Describe a free time activity you enjoyed when you were younger
You should say:
what the activity was
who you did it with
when and where you did it
why you liked it
part 3 for this cue card - 'Leisure time'
I was always a huge fan of video games. When I was a kid, I'd beg my parents to buy me the latest and greatest titles, and I'd spend hours on end lost in virtual worlds. My friends and I would have marathon gaming sessions on the weekends, trying to beat each other's high scores and bragging about our achievements.

I think part of the reason I enjoyed video games so much was because they allowed me to escape from reality. When I was playing a game, I could be anyone or do anything. I could be a hero saving the world from an alien invasion, or a professional athlete competing in the biggest sporting event of the year. It was a way for me to let my imagination run wild and experience things I could never do in real life.

As I grew older, my love of video games only intensified. I saved up my allowance and birthday money to buy every new console that came out, and I spent countless hours exploring every nook and cranny of my favorite games. I even started competing in online tournaments, trying to prove that I was the best in the world at my favorite titles. Now that I'm 24, I still love video games just as much as I did when I was a kid. I may not have as much time to play as I used to, but I still make sure to carve out a few hours every week to indulge in my favorite hobby.

Person you want to work or study with (May to August 2023)

Describe a person you like or want to work or study with
You should say:
who this person is
how long you have known each other
how you met
why you want to work or study with this person
part 3 - 'Classmates, colleagues'

I would be insanely happy if my best friend became my business partner. Together we could start an online store, manufacturing business or pizza shop. We could open a restaurant. Actually, we could start whatever business we want.

The main reason why I want to go into business with him is that I'm sure he is able to build a very successful company 'cause he's a natural-born entrepreneur. All our friends say that if he started a business, he would make lots and lots of money. And I want to be involved (LOL). We've been friends since childhood. And as far as I remember, as a child, he came up with lots of quick and easy ways to make money almost every day. For example, he did a lot of garage sales. When he ran out of junk from our parents' garage to sell, he asked his friends if they could organize garage sales at their houses. Also, he sold homemade lemonade in the summer. Once, and that's one of my favourite stories, he figured out that he could invest, say, $3 into buying the whole pizza and then sell it by the slice. So he was able to charge something like $4 or $5 for a pizza that cost him just $3. I consider him a genius. And I think these stories prove that he does have a business flair. So everyone says that it's a pity that he used his talent only when he was a kid. What's more, he already has extensive experience in sales, which is sometimes key to success in business. Also, we complement each other very well. We would engage in different activities and have different responsibilities. So I believe there would be less reason to fight. Finally, what's important is that we know each other inside out and I know trust him.

Gift you got (May to August 2023)

Describe a gift you got
You should say:
what it was
how you got it
what you did
how you felt about it
Part 3 for this cue card is 'Goals, rewards'

I've been working as a nurse for several years, and I have always enjoyed helping people and making a difference in their lives. One day, I was assigned to care for a patient named Jack, who had been hospitalized with a serious illness. I spent a lot of time with Jack and his family, answering their questions, providing support and comfort, and coordinating his care with the rest of the medical team. Jack and his family were very grateful for the care and support that I provided, and they wanted to show their appreciation. One day, they surprised me with a gift of a box of chocolates. When I saw it, I was blown away 'cause I was touched by their thoughtfulness.

It was hard for me to accept the gift because I didn't want my patient to think that I was only doing my job for the purpose of being rewarded. I cared about his and his well-being, and I wanted to make sure that he received the best care possible. Of course, I was grateful for his appreciation, but I accepted the gift only after I told him that I was doing my job because I wanted to help and make a difference in his life, not because I expected anything in return. I took the box of chocolates home with me and shared them with my family, and we all enjoyed them together. I will always remember the kindness and appreciation shown to me by Jack and his family, and it will always be a special moment in my career as a nurse.

I took the box of chocolates home with me and shared them with by family, and we all enjoyed them together. I will always remember the kindness and appreciation shown to me by Jack and his family, and it will always be a special moment in my career as a nurse.

Complaint (May to August 2023)
Describe a complaint you made and you were satisfied with the results

You should say:
when it happened
who you complained to
what you complained about
why you were satisfied with the results
part 3 for this cue card is 'Complaints'

Just a couple of months ago I had to buy a new laptop because my old one was freezing every 5 seconds, which drove me mad. At first, I wanted to find a suitable one online, but I was overwhelmed by the number of options available. In the end, I decided to go to a reputable electronics store as I wasn't ready to throw money away and buy the first thing I saw online. So I went to the store.

The shop assistant listened to me really carefully and quickly helped find the right solution for my individual needs, not just sold me something because that 'something' would pay him more. Unfortunately, the laptop I'd chosen appeared to be out of stock, so he said he would contact other branches to find the model I wanted. He said this would take a day or two. Of course, I agreed to wait a bit. I asked the shop assistant to keep me updated in order to understand whether I would get the laptop or have to find it elsewhere. However, I had been kept totally in the dark about what the situation was like for about a week until I contacted the shop's customer support service myself and complained about it.

A customer service manager listened to me very carefully. Then she sincerely apologized for the trouble I had to experience with the company and promised to deal with this issue as quickly as humanly possible. The manager called me back within 30 minutes and told me about what had happened. She promised I would get my order the following day. I did get it. Also, the company offered me a big discount, which was very nice. Several days later she called me again to make sure everything was ok. This way, she let me know that she hadn't forgotten about me. It may not sound like much, but it really made me feel valued as a customer. And I really appreciated that.

Something you'd like to learn (May to August 2023)

Describe something that you would like to learn in the future

You should say:
what you would like to learn to do
how and where you would learn it
why you would like to learn to do this
whether it will be difficult or not
part 3 - 'Making decisions, learning things'

On countless occasions I say to myself 'I wish I could edit graphics in Photoshop'. Then I always put it off until I could find time. And although the right moment hasn't come yet, this is what I still really want to learn to do.

First of all, it would be beneficial for my business as I need to create posters, leaflet designs or images for my Facebook page and website almost every day. And it is very important for these images to be simple, yet, attractive and informative. Sometimes I can make them myself if I just need to crop or resize the image using Microsoft Paint.

However, when I need some more advanced manipulations, I have to hire a designer. Unfortunately, I'm sure that in most cases it would be much faster to do it myself than to explain a designer what idea I have in my head. Also, I love taking pictures and being taken pictures of. These photos never come out perfect after the first snapshot, therefore I usually take hundreds of them before I feel satisfied with the result. If only I could use Photoshop, I think I would have to take half as many.

This software has a reputation for being hard to learn but, thank God, there are a number of online courses and video tutorials to practice along with. So even though I usually work long hours and often have to go to work at weekends, I'll be able to master this skill at home and learn at my own pace whenever I have a spare moment. If it appears as difficult as it seems, one day I'll find the time to take an extensive course at a local occupational school.

I don't think I'll ever regret as this is the skill that will pay off forever. Moreover, it's always interesting to try something new. You know, it's a nice way to relieve the stress when you do what is not a part of your daily routine.

PART 3

History (May to August 2023)

Do you agree that learning history may help people understand the present?
Is it true that modern society has much to learn from the past?
Absolutely. I'm convinced that the past causes the present. I mean events in the past have made us what we are today. So any time we want to know why something happened, whether it be a shift in political party dominance in some country, a major change in the teenage suicide rate, or a war in some part of the world, we need to look further back to identify the causes of the change or event. And we don't need to go far in the search for proof. The evidence is everywhere. We live in societies with complex cultures, rules, traditions, values and religions that have not been created on the spur of the moment. They were created in response to something which happened in the past. Also, communities speak languages that are inherited from the past. And, of course, nowadays people use many things that were invented in the past. If our ancestors hadn't invented, say, the wheel and the internal combustion engine, we would probably still travel on horses or on foot.

Why is it that some leaders fail to learn from the past?

To my mind, most leaders ignore the lessons of history because of the lust for power and wealth mixed with indifference and a lack of concern. I mean all they want is more money, more power, bigger territories. And they don't care about the way their people live. They may govern the country that occupies one-sixth of the world's surface. However, instead of improving the lives of this country's citizens, the leader invades neighbouring independent countries trying to seize more territory. Also, they think they are more clever than the leaders of the past who made a mistake or the wrong decision that cost a lot. They think they will act differently, and by differently, they mean better.

How can technology make learning history more interesting?
Well, I think that technology can make learning history more interesting by transforming any lecture into an exciting, engaging lesson. Yeah, technology definitely livens up history lessons and excites interest in the subject by letting students experience learning through gaming, giving them a chance to create their-own- adventure type experiences or challenging them to make difficult choices that lead to meaningful outcomes. Altogether, it becomes of much interest to students, promotes their engagement and makes them more willing to soak themselves in history.

How can people learn about history?
Well, in a variety of ways, I guess. For example, by attending History classes and listening to an experienced teacher who won't just retell past events making everyone fall asleep but connect those events to today placing a great emphasis on how people could learn from past mistakes and succeed in the world of tomorrow, which will hold attention during the lecture and survive in memory for years. One more fun and enriching way to learn history is visiting historical sites, memorials and museums. Such places help to bring history alive in a very specific and unique context letting people be active in their learning and construct their own knowledge of history. People can also learn about the past talking to those who lived it, let's say grandparents or veterans, watching films and documentaries which depict historical events and even reading historical novels. So, there are lots of options these days indeed.

How do museums teach people history?
Well, I think museums teach people history by giving people a chance to get up close to artefacts which are a kind of portals to the past. Museum exhibits always inspire interest and engage with history especially when visitors have an opportunity not only to take a closer look at them but also perform different tasks with their help. Doing so helps visitors make connections between objects and specific past events. In making these connections, people are challenged and encouraged to memorise past events and think in new ways. To sum up, objects and interactive experiences offer countless

possibilities and endless discoveries for each museum visitor and that's how history museums provide this unique interactive experience and teach people history.

Will museums be replaced by technology someday?
Oh, it may well happen. In the grand scheme of things, society doesn't need museums, it needs mechanisms for selecting, preserving and communicating information about our past and present. Even these days a powerful website can deliver much more information than a powerful exhibition, and that gives rise to a suggestion that museums can be totally replaced by technology in the future. But I think it's a long-term perspective. Considering a short-term perspective, I think technology will replace not museums themselves but staff working in them. I am certain that quite soon digital tickets will replace physical ones as well as personal digital guides will replace interpretive staff. Oh, and one more thing I can predict for the coming decades is that hand-craft will be replaced by 3D printing.

Are history museums useful?
Definitely, yes. They are great informal learning. environments for both children and adults. They bring. history to life giving people a chance to get up close to artefacts which are a kind of portals to the past. Museum exhibits always inspire interest and engage with history especially when visitors can not only take a closer look at them but also perform different tasks with their help. Doing so helps visitors make connections between objects and specific past events. In making these connections, people are challenged and encouraged to think in new ways. To sum up, objects and interactive experiences offer countless possibilities and endless discoveries for each museum visitor and that's why history museums which provide this unique interactive experience are really useful.

Should museums be free?
Well, it's a tricky question. There is no doubt everyone should have access to cultural resources and educational opportunities museums offer. But I don't think museums should be free for everyone or all the time 'cause they need to pay the bills somehow. I mean they need money to advertise themselves and this way inform people about their exhibitions and installations. They also need financial resource to obtain and restore artefacts for museum exhibits, create engaging. educational tools, personal digital quides and interactive exhibits. I don't think all this is possible without money or only with government grants. So, I would say museums can be free for students and the elderly but shouldn't be free for solvent men and tourists.

Do you think people should remember their family history?

Of course, they should as it will help them understand where they came from and give context to their life. Also, it will bring them closer to their family as when people begin their family history journey, they may end up discovering new family members all over the world for instance. One more reason to remember family history is because it boosts people's emotional health as well as empowers people's decisions about their physical health as knowing their family history can help raise their awareness about their risks of developing the same problems and empower them to look after their own health to prevent issues - whether that means changes to the diet or speaking to a family doctor about their next steps. Plus, it provides a deeper understanding of culture and traditions as it helps people discover how their ancestors and wider family celebrated different events and whether they were from the same or different cultural background or religion which can help people expand their horizons and strengthen their understanding of their own beliefs.

Neighbours (May to August 2023)

Do you think it is easier for people to get to know each other if they live in the countryside?
Undoubtedly yes. First of all, rural areas have a tradition of neighbors helping each other out because the quick access to services can be limited compared to the faster pace of city life. This means people have a tendency to be warm and welcoming, often prepared to really get to know each other. Secondly, rural communities often can have well-established village halls that host all sorts of events ranging from local garden club meetings to antique fairs, which offers a great way to connect with those who live nearby. So I totally agree It's much easier for people to get to know each other if they live in the countryside than in big cities.

How do children build relationships with others in a community?
First of all, they do it by indulging in activities that help them spend time with their neighbors, such as joining all kinds of clubs and activities on the playground, in the yard or at local parks where they can meet other kids and adults with the same or similar interests and learn to communicate and interact with them. Such interactions usually let kids enjoy positive contact and, as a result, build strong relationships. One more good

way to build and strengthen relations with other people in a community I can think of is to show interest in them and give them a hand when they need it, for instance, by helping neighbors collect their mail when they are on holiday.

Do you think it's important to have a good relationship with neighbours?
Of course, it is. We are social creatures and it's important for us to have communication and positive relationship with people around, and especially with the ones who live next door. What's more, neighbours are people we can always rely on in case of emergency. They are close to us and will always find ways to help us out in a difficult situation. The better our relations with neighbours are, the more help and support we will get from them. Neighbours we have friendly relations with will always give us a helping hand when we are away by collecting our mail, watering flowers, feeding. pets and just keeping an eye on our flats or houses. This will help us remain calm and enjoy our trip or vacation. We can also ask our neighbours to look after our kids if we need to work late or just want to visit some party. So, it's really important to have a friendly relationship with people living nearby.

How can people improve relationships with their neighbours?
Well, first of all, by introducing themselves to neighbours. If people are new in the house or in the area, they should get acquainted with neighbours and then smile and say hello to them whenever they meet them. They should try to be nice to neighbours initiating a relationship with them by striking up interesting conversations or inviting them for a meal. Also, it's a good idea to offer neighbours help with something, for example, with shopping when they are ill or with taking care of their kids while they are at work. One more thing which can help strengthen neighbour relations, to my mind, is celebrating special moments together.

Do you think people's relationships with their neighbours today are the same as they were in the Past?
Do you think people are familiar with their neighbours?
Well, I think it depends on people's values and lifestyles. Those of us who value relations with people who live nearby haven't changed anything in communication with our neighbours. We spend some evenings and days-off together having backyard BBQ parties in summer or throwing house parties in late autumn and winter in just the same way it was a decade and more ago. We keep an eye on each other's houses or flats when one of the families is away. We give each other a helping hand and support each other in hard times in exactly the same way we did it in the past. But those of us who are working a lot these days and don't want to spend free time with neighbours have changed neighbour relations opting for strengthening family bonds or just devoting time to ourselves.

What factors help neighbours to have good relations with each other?
Oh, the same factors which help all people to build strong healthy relations, I think. The most important factor, to my mind, is respecting each other. Because it's impossible to build good relations with people you dislike or disrespect. I also guess it's important to trust each other and have a shared philosophy of life including values and priorities. I would also add that it's great if people do things which make each other happy as well as enjoy and value time together. Oh, and, of course, people should have a commitment to work through conflicts and disagreements in a respectful manner.

What makes a neighbourhood a good one to live in?
Well, I think the quality of neighbourhood, first of all. I mean its physical beauty, the number of trees and flowers, the design of buildings, in other words, its aesthetic character. One more important factor is a variety of functional attributes that contribute to a resident's day-to-day living, for example, great schools and kindergartens, outdoor activities abound, access to medical care, proximity to public transport and, of course, nearby shopping and restaurants. Oh, and the top priority is the safety factor - good street lighting and a low crime rate. Yeah, that's what differs a good neighbourhood from an ordinary one.

Eating out (May to August 2023)

Will you choose a cafe or a restaurant when you meet others?
Oh, a cafe definitely. Cafes serve coffee, cakes, light snacks and a variety of hot and cold beverages, so they are a perfect place for conversing on any topic enjoying some drink and sweet stuff. What's more, they offer a light casual environment which makes me feel more open with friends and close people. I really enjoy their great cosy atmosphere which lets me feel at home and focus only on the conversation without thinking if I am sitting right, eating right and if I am not laughing too loudly breaking formal restaurant etiquette. They are also less expensive than restaurants, which gives me more freedom of choice. All these reasons taken together push me to choose a cafe for friend get- togethers again and again.

What are the differences between a cafe and a restaurant?
Well, I think these days the distinctions between cafes and restaurants have narrowed down greatly leaving just a couple of distinguishing features. One of them, to my mind, is the ambience. A cafe is a casual eating. place serving mainly coffee, light snacks and sweet stuff while a restaurant is a more formal dining place serving a greater variety of foods and offering much more varied service. One more difference that comes to my

mind is the price. Cafes are usually less expensive than restaurants. I can also add that cafes are an ideal place for family and friend get-togethers 'cause they give guests more freedom while restaurants are perfect for formal business meetings and conversations. What kind of people like to go to cafes? Well, absolutely different types of people, I should say. For example, young moms spending time with their little kids who are ready to pay for the relaxing space away from home and everyday routine or stressed workers taking a much-needed atmosphere change trying to eat at least something in between conversations on the phone and on Zoom. Also, I can't help but mention students who skip their lectures in universities or girls finishing up their shopping trips. Well, some other types of regular cafe-goers include booklovers who can pass hours having a cup of coffee and a cake and being glued to a good book, people who set up their office in a cafe spending the whole day working on the laptop while chewing something and even business people who have enough money to eat out but no time to cook at home.

Is it expensive to eat out in your country?
I think it depends on where to eat, the same as everywhere in the world. If you choose a posh restaurant for having dinner and plan to order a fine bottle of wine to pair with your food, you must be ready that it will cost a fortune. But if you just need a change of scenery and opt for a cafe, it's quite affordable. To sum up, there is an appropriate place for everyone in my country irrespective of their income.

Why do young people like to study in a cafe instead of at home?
Oh, I guess that young people often opt for studying in a cafe for two main reasons - a special ambiance which increases creativity, alertness and ability to learn, and the obvious proximity to a caffeine source which energizes and unwinds the body as well as boosts the brain to store long-term memories and, of course, for a number of other less important reasons, for example, an unlimited amount of time they can be on the Internet, a low probability of being bothered, especially if they appear to be studying, and at the same time a chance to have fun study breaks like chatting with people around or looking through magazines Oh, and also, a chance to study outside if the weather is nice as there are often outdoor chairs in cafes.

Internet, TV, libraries (May to August 2023)

Why do people like to read news on the Internet instead of on TV?

There are several reasons why many people prefer to read news on the Internet instead of on TV. First, the Internet allows for more convenient access to news. People can access news on their phones, tablets, or computers at any time. Nobody wants to be tied to a specific TV schedule. This allows people to stay up to date on current events at their own pace, not to feel rushed to watch a news program before it ends. Second, the Internet allows for a wider variety of news sources instead of being limited to the few options available on TV. This allows people to get a more diverse range of perspectives and helps to prevent media bias. Third, the Internet allows for more interactive and personalized news experiences. Many online news sites offer personalized recommendations based on a person's interests and history of news consumption. Thus, people get news that is more tailored to their interests. They aren't presented with a one-size-fits-all news program. For example, if someone is interested in politics and environmental issues, they can easily find online news sources that focus on these topics. And people don't have to go through a general news program that may not cover these issues as heavily.

What are the most popular apps in your country?
Well, I think all possible kinds of apps. Many people use news apps because it's important for everyone, especially nowadays, to keep up with current events and know what is happening in the world. Also, a number of people play mobile games just to relax or pass the time while waiting for somebody or queuing Apps for business are popular too, for example, email apps, apps for editing documents, reminders, notepad apps, a currency converter and a calculator. People want to be able to do their work wherever they are, even on the go. Finally, many people in my country use productivity apps such as a photo editor, an alarm clock, some trip planners, to name but a few.

Technology (May to August 2023)

Why do big companies introduce new products frequently?
In a competitive market, companies need to continuously innovate and introduce new products to stay ahead of their competitors. This is especially important in industries where technology is constantly evolving. Secondly, companies constantly conduct market research to identify new needs and preferences of their customers. Introducing new products that cater to these changing needs helps companies stay relevant and

attract new customers. For example, if a company notices that more and more people are interested in sustainable products, it may introduce a line of eco friendly products. Also, by introducing new products, a company can tap into new market segments and generate additional revenue. This can be especially useful for companies that are looking to expand into new geographic regions or industries. For example, Coca-Cola introduces new flavors and products, such as Coke Energy, to attract new customers and increase sales. Finally, companies may introduce new products as a way to refresh their brand and keep it relevant to consumers. This can be especially important for companies that have been around for a long time want to appeal to a younger generation of consumers.

Why are people so keen on buying iPhones even though they haven't changed much from one to the next?

In my opinion, the main reason is that many people are loyal to the Apple brand and enjoy using their products. They feel a sense of satisfaction and pride in owning an iPhone. What's more, the iPhone is part of a larger ecosystem of products and services, including the App Store, iCloud, and Apple Music. This makes it an attractive option for people who are already invested in this ecosystem. People get used to this system very fast, and soon cannot do without it. Plus, even if the overall design of the iPhone hasn't changed much from one model to the next, each new model often includes new features and improvements that can make it an attractive option for people looking to upgrade. Finally, for some people, owning an iPhone is a status symbol. They may feel that it reflects their social standing or success.

Cities (May to August 2023)

Why are historical cities popular?

In my opinion, historical cities are popular because they offer a glimpse into the past and the opportunity to learn about the history and culture of a particular place. These cities often have well-preserved historical landmarks and architecture, such as castles, churches, and ancient ruins, which can be interesting and educational to visit. In addition, historical cities often have a rich cultural heritage, with a variety of museums art galleries, and cultural events that showcase the history and traditions of the area. Many people find it fascinating to learn about the past and to see how people lived in different time periods, which can be a maior draw for historical cities. And, of course, historical cities provide a beautiful and photogenic backdrop for tourists and photographers.

Why do people go to other cities?

There are many reasons why people visit other cities. Some may be interested in the tourist attractions, cultural events, or sporting events offered by a particular city. Others may visit to spend time with family or friends, or to attend business meetings or educational events. Some people visit other cities for health-related reasons, while others are attracted to the local cuisine or shopping options. Others may be seeking adventure or a chance to relax and get away from their everyday lives. Regardless of the specific reason, visiting another city can be an exciting and enriching experience, offering the opportunity to try new things and broaden one's horizons.

Do you think tourists may come across bad things in other cities?
Tourists visiting other cities may encounter a variety of challenges and negative experiences. First of all, tourists may be more vulnerable to crime, such as pickpocketing or scams, when visiting a new city. For example, a tourist visiting a new city may have their wallet stolen by a pickpocket while riding on public transportation. Plus, tourists may offend local customs or traditions due to a lack of understanding of the culture. For instance, a tourist visiting a city with a different cultural tradition may accidentally offend local customs by wearing inappropriate clothing or by behaving in a way that is considered rude or disrespectful. Another difficulty tourists may be faced with is a language barrier. I mean tourists may have difficulty communicating with locals if they do not speak the same language. This can make it harder to get around, find places to eat or stay, or get help if needed 'cause tourists may have difficulty communicating with hotel staff, restaurant servers, or taxi drivers. Finally, tourists may be more prone to illness when visiting a new city due to different type of bacteria, viruses, and environmental factors.

Skills (May to August 2023)

What practical skills can young people teach old people?

In my opinion, young people can teach old people a variety of practical skills, depending on their interests and abilities. First of all, many young people are very comfortable with technology and may be able to teach older people how to use smartphones, tablets, laptops, and other devices. They can also show older people how to navigate online platforms, do online shopping and other internet-based activities. Plus, young people can teach old people how to use social media platforms to stay connected with others and to stay up-to-date on current events, how to use apps, for example, fitness apps or equipment to stay active and healthy, and messengers to communicate with family and friends. And, of course, younger people can teach seniors to use modern kitchen equipment and utensils such as a slow cooker or coffee machine.

How can we teach an older generation to use new technology?
Well, considering their perspective and understanding their history with technology, first of all. I guess the most important thing is to keep everything simple providing the elderly with step-by-step demonstrations rather than pushing too much all at once. It's important to help them see how new technology can positively impact their life, help them focus on the human elements of modern technology, I mean let them experience the joys of sending an email to a close friend or relative without waiting several days or weeks to get a reply via the mail service and, of course, walk them slowly through all these steps with as much support and care as possible.

What's the difference between children learning and adults learning what they have to learn?
Oh, I guess the main difference is the fact that children are dependent on their teacher to lead the learning. while adults are self-directed and usually prefer to be responsible for what they choose to learn. What's more, kids are motivated by external pressures and the consequences of failure while adults learn because of a desire of self-improvement, recognition and self- confidence. And the last difference I can name is that while learning kids mostly rely on the experience of their teacher unlike adults who always rely on their own life experience.

Where can we learn practical skills?
Well, there is a variety of ways to learn practical skills nowadays. The most traditional of them are to ask a friend who already has this skill to show and practise it with you, address a specialist with a request for an expert advice or attend some training_programmes, masterclasses or workshops. There are also many much more popular present-day alternatives such as video tutorials, blogs and forums, mobile applications and webinars which are successfully used for learning and practising different kinds of skills just with a click of a button without a need to leave your room.

Being late (May to August 2023)
Why are people often late for meetings or appointments?
In my opinion, the main reason why people come late to meetings is a lack of planning. I mean the person may not have allowed enough time to get to the meeting or appointment, or they may have scheduled too many things too close together. Sometimes if the person has to travel to the meeting or appointment, they may be delayed by heavy traffic, construction, accidents, or other unexpected road conditions. Another common reason for being late is personal emergencies. For example, the person couldn't find their keys and had to spend 20 minutes searching for them, or their child was running a fever and the person had to stay home until the babysitter arrived.

In some cases, people are late for meetings just because the person may not see the meeting or appointment as being very important, and therefore not prioritize it accordingly.

Do you think it's important to be on time?
Absolutely. Whether it's a doctor's appointment, a meeting with a client, or a hair appointment, or a get- together with your friends, being on time shows that you value the other person's time. Being punctual at work or school demonstrates responsibility, reliability and a good work ethic. It also gives you time to settle in and prepare for the tasks ahead. As far as meetings are concerned, punctuality is important 'cause it allows the meeting to start and end as scheduled. And it shows respect for the other attendees. Plus, it's important to be on time for flights, trains, and other forms of transportation in order to avoid missing your trip. If you don't come on time, you won't reach your destination as planned. As for various events, it is important to be on time in order to get a good seat without disturbing other attendees. Also, it ensures that you don't miss out on any important moments or activities.

Pollution (May to August 2023)

What can people do together to improve the local environment?
How can air pollution be reduced effectively?
Well, first of all, people should plant lots of trees and flowers where they live as well as organize or participate in park and river cleanup events as these actions will help them combat climate change and clean the air and the area around. One more thing people should do together is to start using bicycles instead of cars or share car rides to work and back with coworkers or neighbours as it will help reduce greenhouse gas emissions. Well, and of course, people can do lots of other simple things such as using less packaging,. recycling items like plastic bags, aluminum foil, glass, batteries and beer tops, unplugging unused electronics and reusing old items, which are absolutely senseless if taken by one or few people and become noticeable when done by a big number of people on a regular basis.

Do you think modern means of transportation cause harm to the environment?
Of course, they do as transport is a major user of energy, and burns most of the world's petroleum, which creates air pollution. It is also a significant contributor to global warming through emission of carbon dioxide and a major source of greenhouse gas

emissions. One more negative impact of transport is traffic congestion and automobile-oriented urban sprawl, which can consume natural habitat and agricultural lands. So yeah, regrettably, modern means of transportation,. exclusive of electric cars, have negative effects on Earth's air quality, acid rain, smog, climate change and the environment on the whole.

Who should take responsibility for protecting the environment?
I am sure that it should be a shared responsibility because, on the one hand, it is individuals that create a lot of waste through their actions. And much of what people do every day cannot be controlled by the government. So I think that individuals can do a lot for protecting our planet. For example, they can turn lights off when they are not in the room,_grow their own food and ride a bike or walk instead of driving a car. They can also buy organic foods and cleaning products that contain natural biodegradable ingredients. It would be great if all people recycled bottles, cans, paper and clothes and fitted solar panels to their houses. All or even one of these actions would help to protect the environment and prolong human life. On the other hand, there is no way to adequately address environmental issues without a strong commitment from the government. Only government can raise public awareness and participation in environmental protection, set tougher emissions or fuel efficiency standards, punish companies that cause major environmental disasters and, of course, address global environmental problems on the international level attract all members of international community to solving this type of problems worldwide.

Transportation, leisure facilities (January - August 2023)
What's the most popular means of transportation in your hometown?
How do people travel to work?
I can safely say that the majority of people here get around by subway. The main reason is that you don't have to worry about a possibility of getting stuck in a traffic jam. Also, trains run frequently, therefore people get anywhere in time even during peak hours. In addition, this mode of transport is relatively. inexpensive, reliable and really comfortable.

Do you prefer public transportation or private transportation?
I prefer getting around in a private vehicle because I don't like to be dependent on other people. I like the idea that I can stop whenever and wherever I want. I can take as much stuff with me as need. I can speak loudly and sing. So, although many of my friends say that the amount of money I spent to purchase my car could generally finance public transit fees for years, I'm not planning to switch to mass transit.

What needs to be improved in public transport?
Well, I think that the first measure that should be implemented in order to improve public transport is to buy higher end bus models that are quieter, have a smooth ride and are fuel efficient as this would make bus rides more comfortable for riders and less expensive for local authorities. Next, it would be a great idea to speed up vehicle boarding by using off-vehicle fare collection, for example. Also, it would be good if there were lanes dedicated especially for the use of public transport and if public transport was given priority at traffic signals as these measures would make commuting faster. Oh, and, of course, it would be great to provide good information on paper, online, on the bus, and on the route about where buses go to and where transfers are located or even implement an app for smartphones combined with a call-in service that allows real time bus information for each line and every stop. Yeah, such improvements would significantly improve public transport, to my mind.

Do people in your country like to go to a cinema to watch a film?
Definitely. There are always a lot of people at the cinema. So we can assume cinemas are in great demand as they let people focus on the movie and not get distracted, which people value. What's more, it's a good way to spend time out. How often do you go to a cinema to watch a movie? Well, I go to a cinema every time there is a new release. My friends call me a movie freak but I just enjoy watching films on the big screen and getting pulled into the sound and colour in a way that can't be felt at home.

Old people, selfishness (May to August 2023)
What are the benefits of being interested in other people?
Oh, I think that the main benefit of taking interest in others is feeling good. Showing others that we care about them makes them feel needed. This gives us a greater meaning and purpose in life as well as brings us joy and a sense of worth. It also builds a greater connection with people and, as a result, opens up more opportunities. For example, helps us find a good job get acquainted with someone we might fall in love with or get a good price for some item we want to sell. In the longer term, it also helps us influence other people and get what we need from them whenever we need it.

What problems in society can being self- centered cause?
Well, to my mind, self-centeredness can give rise to a number of problems. For example, it may lead to inability to cooperate with others, especially those who have opposing views, which as a result, may disintegrate families and marriages as well as destroy relationships with friends and business partners. It may also lead to difficulties

with seeing the plights of others who are less fortunate, which will cut off dialogue between people, communities and nations and weaken society and nation-building.

What kinds of things can young people learn from old people?
To my mind, old people can teach the young lots of things starting from different necessary skills to attitude to themselves, people around them and life. But I guess that the most important lessons they can teach young people are to stay positive in any situation and remember that there is always a way to make a difference and change life, to never let the learning. stop, remembering that wisdom is something they acquire over ages but not something they are born with, to appreciate blessings in life, to be grateful for what they have, to take care of health and, of course, to value their bonds and people they included in their life.

Goals, rewards, feeling proud (May to August 2023)

Do people usually set different goals at different stages of life?
Is there any difference between children's ambitions and those of grown-ups?
Absolutely! I think this happens because as we get older, we start to view life differently and, as a result, experience changes in the aspects of life we consider important. For another thing, both our needs and values change as we pass through different stages in life, from our childhood to adulthood. In our teens, we usually want to save money to buy some cool gadget or toy. Also, as teens we usually strive for wining in some contests or championships, visiting some place, or learning something and getting good marks at school. As we start into college, our focus changes into getting good grades to be competitive when we start looking for a job. As we become young professionals, our goal is to grow both personally and professionally, and earn good money. The next stage is to create a strong and friendly family. And then, when we reach middle age and older, we focus on staying healthy and prolonging our life. To sum up, our goals change due to the far* that during life we undergo different steps, development and transformation that make us re and necessitate various things.a

On what occasions would adults feel proud of themselves?
Well, most adults feel proud of their accomplishments, whether they are connected with their professional activity or personal growth. For example, people may feel proud when they get recognized for their work, get a promotion or high-paying job. Also, people may feel proud when they support good causes, make charitable donations or help their friends and relatives resolve problems or conflicts. Another thing that makes people proud of themselves is when they manage to deal with some life difficulties. For instance, some people manage to avoid repeating the same mistakes, persist and don't give up when things get tough, overcome their fears and reach their goals. Finally,

people may feel proud of the status and wealth they achieved, for example, if they managed to buy a car or flat, or something they had been dreaming about for a while.

What rewards can companies offer to outstanding employees?
What rewards are important at work?
Well... any rewards that will make them feel special and valued, for example, letting them be 'CEO for the day' spending the day shadowing the CEO of the company or introducing them to the 'VIPs' in the organization, I mean upper members of the management team or key customers. I also think it will be a good idea for companies to invest in their personal development sending them to a seminar or educational activity of interest, or just give them a spa day or other special treatment. Well, and of course, it would be great to provide them with office perks like a good parking place, a comfortable room and tasty nutritious lunch.

Leisure time (May to August 2023)

Do you think nowadays people have a better work-life balance than in the past?
How do people balance life and work?
I'd say they do as nowadays the world offers so many different ways to work and study that sacrificing personal life looks more like a mindset than a real problem. A lot of present-day employers do their best to help their employees have a good work-life balance by offering flexible work hours, the ability to work from home, improved overall workplace experience and opportunities for professional growth and social connections. So, even if many people are doing more work these days, it's only because it allows them to earn more money and live their lives to the fullest. What's more, at this day and age, fewer people have false expectations that they can have a lot of free time and earn a lot of money at the same time, which has helped them define what lifestyle they really want to have and enjoy sticking to it feeling satisfied and happy

Is it important to have a break during work or study?
Believe it's not just important, but essential to have enough rest because we aren't robots and our brain and body cannot work nonstop maintaining the same levels of productivity. If we don't get enough rest, the only likely outcome is a burnout. So breaks serve as a so-called system reboot after which you will feel rested and energetic and therefore satisfied with your life.

What leisure activities do old and young people prefer?
Well, young people usually like spending time out either attending different events or just having fun with friends anywhere, be it a cafe or a sports club. They also like

spending time around people, building a strong network of contacts and opening a whole world of opportunities. While old people prefer to entertain at home receiving guests, watching TV, doing something. with their hands and just taking care of their beloved ones. Some old people also like gardening and walking as far as I know.

What do young people do in their free time?
How do students relax?
Oh, I guess it depends on young people, their likes and dislikes as well as interests and hobbies. I think a lot of them spend plenty of their spare time with friends either attending youth clubs, taking extra classes or just windowshopping in central malls. In warm seasons the young spend time in the parks cycling, skateboarding. and playing different sports. In the evenings they visit cinemas, concerts and discos or spend time in pubs having a couple of glasses of beer and a good laugh. It's also quite popular among youth to travel around the country and abroad.

What are some examples of ways that people use to relax?
Oh, I guess different people opt for different relaxation methods. Some people give preference to doing yoga, meditating and stretching to relieve muscle tension. Others choose pampering themselves with a health spa, beauty treatment or a good massage. There are also people who just need to meet friends or spend time with beloved ones to relax. Active people opt for such rest as working out in the gym, dancing or going shopping. I can also name such nice ways to relax as taking a bath, cuddling with a pet, getting fresh air and listening to favourite music.

What is the difference in the way people spend their free time nowadays and 20 or 30 years ago?
Well, I think 2 or 3 decades ago people spent most of their time outdoors either playing sport or working in the garden. They also did a lot of household chores, received guests and paid visits to relatives, friends and neighbours. As far as nowadays are concerned, people spend most of their spare time surfing the net, playing. computer games and communicating with others in social networks. They also take a lot of extra classes, exercise, devote time to hobbies and travel around their countries and abroad.

What do people in your country do in their spare time?
Oh, nowadays a lot of people living in my country exercise after work and at weekends. I guess it's because more and more people understand that physical exercise is important for both physical and mental health as it gives a release after a day or week of stress. Many people devote quite a lot of their free time to reading and taking extra classes never stopping learning new aspects of the world around them. They also spend plenty of time on their hobbies which are a kind of a breath of fresh air that keeps

them grounded and in some cases even offers networking opportunities. And, of course, spend time with family. and friends, surf the net, entertain and travel as much as they can afford.

What kind of sports are popular in your country?
Oh, I would say all kinds of ball games. People in my country are fond of football because it has simple rules, can be played just with a ball almost anywhere, is very entertaining to watch and play and very short which makes viewers actively involved in the game from the beginning to the end. There are also a lot of basketball and volleyball fans. Basketball can be played with 5 or more friends all at the same time and provides a whole lot of fun. Volleyball is very aerobic and athletic and attracts people with its strategy. These days there are also lots of people in my country enjoying tennis which is one of the most dynamic sports requiring total involvement of its players. Tennis encourages interaction, communication and just plain fun and is a great stress reliever which makes it even more loveable.

Leisure time (May to August 2023)

Why do many people nowadays say there aren't enough hours in the day?
Do you think that not having enough time is a feature of our modern life?
Do people have enough time for leisure activities nowadays?
In my opinion, most people are feeling pressed for time as the society's standards for success are very high these days, which puts people under great pressure. As a result, many people work longer hours, and their work schedules are becoming more and more exhausting. Some people work multiple jobs. All this leaves them with objectively less free time for rest and sleep. Not getting enough rest causes people to perform worse than they ordinarily would, even with the aid of caffeine or other products. And when people perform slower than they otherwise would, it's inevitable that they feel that time is always slipping away. Plus, nowadays people seem unwilling to accept the fact that they can't fit everything in 'cause they don't want to let anyone down, and they can't say no, so most people are now biting off more than they can chew. For example, they try to force work, children, friends, bread baking,. jogging, and weekly virtual yoga into their schedules. Many people try layering tasks, such as listening to music or a podcast while organizing their office. Of course, all this leaves people with the sense that they just don't have enough time to get everything done and never have time for themselves.

Classmates, colleagues (May to August 2023)

What do you think makes someone a good colleaque?

What matters most about a colleague's personality?
What do you think makes someone a good colleague?
Well, a number of factors and characteristics, to my mind. A good colleague is someone who knows what to say and do to make others feel peaceful rather than more stressed, who doesn't gossip or run people down and treats everyone with the same amount of respect. It's also someone who reaches out and offers practical help when they see that their colleagues are exhausted overwhelmed or just stuck. They are intuitive and thoughtful, reliable and punctual and socially sensitive. Oh, and they are willing to contribute however they can in going the extra mile in solving problems.

Do you think that having good colleagues is the most important thing at work?
Are good colleagues important at work?
Well, I am not sure if I can say that it's the most important thing at work but I am more than sure that it's very important for the majority of people as it's the real secret to staying happy at work. It's something that saves people from anxiety, depression and other stress-related ailments. Having good colleagues has a dramatic positive effect on people's moods and helps them feel more connected to their place of employment. It's a kind of a little delight amid the tedium, which is important for employees to thrive. So yeah, friendly relations with colleagues are very important for job satisfaction.

Does it matter if a child likes their classmates?
Of course, it does. If children like their classmates, they. look forward to coming to school because friendly relations create a comfortable atmosphere in the class and help kids have a sense of belonging. What is more, affection for classmates is crucial to academic success as it unites children, unleashes their untapped potential and creates a drive for them to study harder and perform better. In contrast, if kids don't like their classmates, they feel disconnected and left out, and just don't want to go to school, or even if they do go there, they can't perform well as they have many fears like fear of making mistakes, fear of ridicule or fear of being laughed at. So, fellow-feelings matter, without doubt.

How can children get along with their classmates?
Well, I guess they, first of all, should smile whenever they make eye contact with their classmates. It always shows a wish to communicate and helps to break the ice. One more thing I'd recommend them to do is do kind things for their mates like sharing the notes if they missed class to show that they care about developing a positive relationship with them. I also think they can try to improve their relations with class-fellows by taking advantage of social events like dances and sporting. contests when they come up or by inviting them to do something outside of class. As my experience

shows, such extra-curricular activities always help kids get to know each other better and develop positive relations

What kinds of people are popular at work?
Well, I guess the ones who inspire others to be productive, fulfilled and happy at their workplace. These are, first of all, resourceful and focused people or in other words those people who are able to see a solution in just about every problem they encounter and keep the energy in the team high setting on specific tasks instead of messing around a lot. Also, these are visionaries or those people who usually think in decades and have a very clear picture of what they want to accomplish in their lives. Working with such people other team members always have a feeling they are working on something big, something that will stay here as a sign of their teamwork, which is very motivating. Another type of people I consider popular at work are sympathetic people who make a workplace as nice as home, helping others feel good in the place where they spend almost one third of their lives. Finally "have fun' people as they are able to find a way to loosen things up when a stressful situation appears, which makes working with them a pure pleasure.

Are knowledgeable people popular at work?
Sure. Being knowledgeable can certainly be an asset in the workplace and can contribute to a person's popularity among their colleagues 'cause, first of all, most colleagues may appreciate being able to turn to a knowledgeable person for help or advice when they are facing a problem or have a question. Plus, being knowledgeable can help a person build credibility and respect among their colleagues, which can contribute to their popularity. Finally, having a reputation as a knowledgeable person can make a person more valuable to the team or organization, which can also contribute to their popularity. However, it is not the only factor that determines a person's popularity. There are many other things that can contribute to a person being well-liked at work, such as having a friendly personality being a good team player, and having good communication skills. It is important to note that popularity is subjective and what makes one person popular may not necessarily make another person popular.

What benefits are there when a child is popular at school?
Well, one of the very obvious benefits of being popular at school, to my mind, is that school celebrities get preferential treatment from both teachers and classmates. What I mean is they get special tasks from teachers, the ones they want and choose to do, and get all the support they need from their classmates. Also school celebrities are recognized by everyone at school, be it a school security guard or a seller in a cafeteria, which makes them experience confidence and a massive ego boost. So being popular

at school definitely opens many doors which would have remained shut if fame hadn't been achieved.

Gifts and rewards (May to August 2023)

What rewards do children want to get?

Oh, I think that it is praise and attention that kids want to get the most from their parents and close people as it is what they lack the most these days. And then, of course, all kinds of relish like candies, toys, LEGO or games. Some children also really want to be rewarded with a day in the attraction park or a visit to the cinema others - with some extra computer game time or sleepover with a friend. Oh, and of course, with money... this is what both kids and adults want to be rewarded with.

What are children usually rewarded for at school?

Schools offer lots of different awards to students in order to reinforce certain behaviour or encourage them to strive for academic success. First of all, almost all schools provide attendance awards and certificates to students for good or improved attendance 'cause chronic absenteeism is one of the main causes of poor academic performance and higher dropout rates. Secondly, children can be rewarded when they do well in exams, write excellent essays or win a competition, for example, a short story competition, a poetry reading competition, a spelling competition. Other things that children can get rewarded for include good or improved behaviour and good grades.

What rewards can children get from school?

Well, children can get all types of awards and certificates for good behaviour, perfect attendance,. stellar performance, and a special achievement, or, at least, a simple phone call to parents with positive comments. And, of course, something to motivate kids to work even harder and do even better like a few extra credit points to a test or homework score, or homework-free weekend. Oh, I almost forgot to mention such rewards as interesting books or sports equipment, and things like trips out of school, especially instead of school classes.

What rewards can companies offer to outstanding employees?

Well... any rewards that will make them feel special and valued, for example, letting them be 'CEO for the day' spending the day shadowing the CEO of the company or introducing them to the 'VIPs' in the organization, I mean upper members of the management team or key customers. I also think it will be a good idea for companies to invest in their personal development sending them to a seminar or educational activity of interest, or just give them a spa day or other special treatment. Well, and of course, it

would be great to provide them with office perks like a good parking place, a comfortable room and tasty nutritious lunch.

Complaints (May to August 2023)

What products or services do people in your country like to complain about?

Well, I guess that people in my country mostly enjoy complaining about all kinds of retail sales, I mean such stuff as false advertising and other deceptive practices defective merchandise, problems with rebates,_gift cards and certificates and failure to deliver. I've also stumbled upon a big number of complaints about utilities, for example, about service problems or unsafe conditions, failure to make repairs or provide promised amenities, deposit and rent disputes. One more leader on this list is complaints about home improvement or construction. In this sphere people are usually dissatisfied with shoddy work as well as failure to start or complete the job. And one last thing that comes to my mind is such problems as poor client service, lack of communication and rude or uninformed staff.

Would you buy things in the shops which you complained about before?

Well, definitely 'yes' if my complaints were handled successfully as I always grant everyone a second chance. And definitely 'no' if the shops didn't deal with my complaints on a personal basis as I don't want to get a negative experience one more time.

Is it necessary for companies to set up customer service?

I am more than sure that it is, as good customer service makes customers feel that companies care about developing a long-term relationship with them, which makes them want to keep coming back. What is more, it motivates customers to tell their friends and relatives about how well the company has taken care of them resulting in additional advertising at no cost to the company. A good customer service also sets the company apart from its competitors and lets it charge more for its products and services. Oh, and it leads to improved employee morale too, which is very important for any company willing to succeed.

Are there any disadvantages in setting up customer service?

Well, the only disadvantage of setting up customer service I can think of is the costs of running this service, though I don't think it's a drawback as, to mu mind, a good customer service will recover the expenses in full quite fast. So, I would say there are no downsides in building a successful customer service department. Only upsides!

Do you think customers' complaints will improve products or services?
No doubt they will as all companies understand that the more satisfied customers they have, the more profit they will get. Customers' complaints help companies succeed as they can point out vital information that is lacking, erroneous or out of date. What is more, they highlight key areas where the product needs improving, systems need updating or the service needs upgrading. They also give the company valuable content and insightful case studies for its service education programs, so I am sure that companies with clear- sighted vision will do their best to change their products or services for the better as soon as they receive a valid customer complaint.

Making decisions, learning things (January - August 2023)
At what age can children make decisions on their own?
Oh, I'd say kids can make decisions on their own at any age if it happens in a controlled setting with their parents as their guides or if it happens when parents see that their kids demonstrate maturity and readiness to make decisions relevant to their daily experience. What I mean is that children can make their own decisions when they are ready to make choices without their parents' help and are able to understand the information, use it to weigh the pros and cons and effectively communicate their decision defending their reasoning. So, I'd say age is not what it's about.

Do you prefer advice from your family or your friends?
Who do young people turn to for advice?
Well, whenever I need some really important advice, I, first of all, seek it of my parents, 'cause I know that they have more experience and will always give me rational advice based on the lessons they have learnt throughout their life. What is more, they are very reliable and will never betray or harm me. They are always there for me and will help me wholeheartedly in any situation. But if the advice I need is not that vital and doesn't put me at risk or pose threat to my future, will go to my friends because they think like me, know all my ambitions and passions and will never criticise or reprimand me even if I want to do something rash and Irrational.

Actors (May to August 2023)

Is it interesting to be an actor or actress?
Being an actor or actress can be a very interesting and rewarding career for some people, but it can also be challenging and stressful. One interesting aspect of being an actor is that they have the opportunity to portray a wide range of characters and bring their stories to life. Actors often get to work with talented writers, directors, and other actors, and they may have the chance to work on exciting and creative projects. For

example, an actor might get the chance to play a complex and multi-faceted character in a movie, or they might get to perform in a live theater production in front of a live audience. These experiences can be very fulfilling and allow actors to express themselves creatively. However, the acting industry can be very competitive, and it can be difficult to find steady work. Actors may have to audition for many roles before they get a part, and they may have long periods of time where they are not working. Additionally, actors often have to deal with criticism and rejection, which can be challenging to handle. Overall, whether being an actor is interesting or not depends on the individual and their interests and goals. Some people may find the process of creating and portraying characters to be extremely fulfilling, while others may find it stressful or frustrating.

What are the differences between acting in theatre and acting in film?
Acting in a theater and acting in a film are two distinct forms of performance that require different approaches and techniques. One key difference is the audience: in theater, actors perform in front of a live audience, while in film, the audience is not present during the filming. This can affect the performance style of the actor, as theater acting is often more expressive and larger in scale, as the actors need to project their voices and movements to reach the back of the theater. In contrast, film acting is often more subtle and naturalistic, as the camera can capture small facial expressions and gestures. Another difference between theater and film acting is the rehearsal process. Theater productions typically have longer rehearsal periods, during which the actors have the opportunity to work on their characters and blocking (stage movements) in detail. In contrast, film productions have shorter rehearsal periods and may not have rehearsals at all, as the director may prefer to discover the scene spontaneously on set. Additionally, there are differences in the number of takes that actors may have to do for a scene. In film, actors may have to do multiple takes of a scene until the director is sati with the performance, while in theater, actors typically only have one chance to perform a scene each night.

Are there many people in your country who want to work as an actor?
Well, it's hard for me to say if there are many or few people in my country dreaming to become actors but there are definitely some people who are dreaming about it, and I think they want to pursue an artistic career as they love being on stage and portraying. different characters. I also think there are quite a lot of people who want to be actors just because they have an endless craving for attention and a wish to be recognised wherever they go as well as a desire to be rich and famous. So yeah, I guess I can say there are many people wishing to work as actors, or it's better to say, not few.

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